

Demo Account Reference

Internal documentation: how demo accounts work, who can use them, and what they are not allowed to do.

What is a demo account?

A pre-created Firebase Auth account whose Firestore user doc carries *role*: 'demo'. Visitors log in via the normal Sign In form using shared credentials issued by admin. There is no public Demo button. From the visitor's perspective it looks exactly like signing in as a student, with a permanent orange banner reminding them they are in demo mode.

Who is it for?

- Prospective FSM students evaluating the platform before they have an @stu.fsm.edu.tr email.
- Parents or family members wanting to see what their student is using.
- Visiting researchers or guests from other institutions.
- You (admin) for quick QA without polluting analytics.

Where the credentials live

DEMO-CREDENTIALS.pdf — kept on disk at the project root. Share privately, never publicly.

What demo users can do

Area	Demo user
Open the hub and any skill card	Yes
Play Vocabulary activities	Yes — gameplay only, score not saved
Open Reading exam, read text, see questions	Yes (read-only)
Open Listening exam, hear audio, see questions	Yes (read-only)
Submit a Reading or Listening answer	No — Firestore rules block
Join a classroom by code	Yes — appears in roster
Submit answers in classroom	No — blocked
See the list of teacher assignments	Yes (read-only)
Submit an assignment completion	No — blocked
Access the teacher dashboard	No — blocked
Be promoted to teacher	No — permanent restriction

Security model

The demo restrictions are enforced at two layers:

Layer 1 — Firestore rules (server-side)

- Each demo account's user doc has *role*: 'demo'.
- Helper *isDemo()* reads that role.
- Every write rule that matters (sessions, assignmentCompletions, classroom answers, activityLogs) requires *canWriteAsRealUser()* — which excludes demo.
- Reads remain open the same way they are for real students — demo users see the same content but cannot interact with it.

Layer 2 — Client-side guards (UX)

- On dashboard load, *window.isDemoUser* is set when the role is 'demo'.
- The orange banner is injected at the top of the page.
- *logSessionToFirestore()* short-circuits for demo users — no console errors.

Abuse vectors and what stops them

Vector	Mitigation
A demo user tries to submit answers / save progress	Firestore rules reject. Client-side, the submit either short-circuits or fails silently.
A demo user tries to read other users' private data	Same rules as students: only their own user doc, only their own sessions.
A demo user tries to open the teacher dashboard	Client gate redirects to access-denied; even if bypassed, Firestore rules block queries.
A demo user is somehow promoted to teacher	Cannot happen: rules block role:'teacher' writes when target email is @stu.fsm.edu
Credentials leaked publicly	Rotate passwords via create-demo-accounts.js (see DEMO-CREDENTIALS.pdf).
Lots of strangers using the same demo accounts	Acceptable — they cannot affect real data. If concerned, rotate or delete the accounts.

How to disable demos if you ever need to

Two levels, from softest to firmest:

- **Soft — rotate passwords.** Any unauthorised holders can no longer sign in.
- **Hard — delete the accounts.** Firebase Console → Authentication → Users → delete; and Firestore → users → delete each demo user doc.

FAQ

"Can I let a guest teacher try the teacher dashboard?"

Not via demo. Demo role is locked to student-shape access. Create a real account with their email and promote it from the Students tab. Demote when the tour ends.

"Two visitors logged into the same demo account at the same time — is that OK?"

Yes. Firebase Auth allows multiple concurrent sessions on the same account. The shared state is purely cosmetic since demos don't save sessions.

"How do I add a fourth demo account?"

Open `y/tools/create-demo-accounts.js`, add a new entry to the `DEMO_ACCOUNTS` list, run the script. Then update `build_pdfs.py` with the new entry and regenerate this PDF and `DEMO-CREDENTIALS.pdf`.